

THE NOHO RAG – EPISODE 203
GAME NIGHT

Written by

Chaz Wilke

Story by

Chaz Wilke & Jacob Buras

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FADE IN:

INT. NEWS DESK

Dane and Kelly Mae wrap up yet another episode of the news.

DANE
Fascinating story, Kelly Mae.
(beat)
And to think, I use that same brand
of mouth wash.

Kelly Mae nods and Dane addresses the camera:

DANE (CONT'D)
Well for everyone here at NoHo. I'm
Dane Argyle.

KELLY MAE
And I'm Kelly Mae Greenblatt.
(beat)
Y'all have yourselves a good night.

MUSIC STINGER

TITLE CARD

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK - BEHIND CAMERA

Bob is holding his Pepto, takes his signature sigh of relief.
Then holds his stomach in disbelief.

BOB
Oh wow...

Bob looks around the room to the crew.

BOB (CONT'D)
I don't think I need Pepto after
this episode!
(beat)
Great work Kelly Mae!
(beat)
And Dane! Not a single reference to
your digestive system!
(beat)
Progress!
(beat)
This is what progress looks like,
people!

Bob attempts to lead the crew on a round of applause but no one joins in and he quickly feels awkward and just as quickly rebounds into enthusiasm.

Bob points around the room.

BOB (CONT'D)
Game night?
(beat)
Game night?

Bob's question piques Dane's interest.

CUT TO:

INT. NEWS DESK

Dane and Kelly Mae remain sitting at the news desk but more casually.

DANE
Game night?

KELLY MAE
You didn't get the email?
(beat)
Bob invited us to his home for his semi-annual employee game night tonight.
(beat)
He even wrote in the email that a good time was guaranteed. And that if you hate it, you are allowed to mark it as overtime on Monday.

Dane's eyebrow raises.

DANE
Ooh! Let's go!
(beat)
There's no **way** I'll have a good time!
(beat)
OT pay, honey!
(beat)
Dane needs himself a new watch!

CUT TO:

INT. BOB'S APARTMENT - ABOUT THREE HOURS LATER

Bob's apartment is neat but lived in, basically Chaz' place since that's where we're shooting.

The four members of the main staff are sitting around the kitchen table. In this order: Dane, Kelly Mae, Olivia then Bob.

The group is playing the board game LIFE. Empty beers line the table next to the recycle bin. Everyone has clearly had at least two drinks.

DANE

Why isn't news anchor an available profession in this game?

KELLY MAE

Did you just find the next Dane Expose?

Bob becomes interested in the exchange.

BOB

Hey yeah, I still need to have a postmortem with you about that Santa story.

(beat)

I think you are the only person on this planet that thought those cookies looked like hairy vaginas.

(beat)

And poor Santa.

(beat)

Now everyone hates him.

Olivia's interest is piqued.

OLIVIA

Good.

(beat)

Christmas is a socially enforced past due notice that requires **us** to foot the bill and get the year's earnings out of the red for our corporate owners.

Kelly Mae moves her game piece as Olivia finishes.

DANE

Well, looks like Kelly Mae is the proud owner of another human!

Kelly Mae collapses into her seat.

KELLY MAE

Can I just...

(beat)

Not...

(beat)

Have that baby?

Bob scoffs.

BOB

That's not in the rules, Kelly Mae.

KELLY MAE

Yeah, but can't we...

(beat)

Like...

(beat)

Be progressive about this?

BOB

I apologize for the traditional
values of the board game LIFE,
Kelly Mae, but the rules say you
get a beautiful baby girl!

As Bob speaks he reaches into the bag of babies, pulls out a pink one, stretches across the table and sticks the baby in Kelly Mae's game piece.

KELLY MAE

Greeaaaaaat...

Dane leans over to whisper to Kelly Mae.

DANE

(sotto)

Overtime pay.

Kelly Mae's face snaps to contentment.

Dane sips his beer while he scrutinizes Olivia. Olivia feels his gaze and stares back awkwardly.

DANE (CONT'D)

I'm sure I've asked you this
before.

(beat)

But who are you?

Kelly Mae slaps Dane.

OLIVIA
I'm Olivia!
(beat)
I'm the writer here!

Dane stares at Olivia like she's lying.

DANE
We have a writer for this show?
(beat)
Huh, I guess I never thought a news
show **used** one!

BOB
Where do you think the words in the
Teleprompter come from?

Dane shrugs.

DANE
I don't know...
(beat)
The newspaper?

Kelly Mae drops her head into her hands.

KELLY MAE
(sotto)
Jesus.

Bob exclaims while trying to keep it bottled up, a telltale
sign that he will soon need Pepto.

Olivia takes it in stride.

OLIVIA
I've worked here for nearly two
years and I write everything you
read.
(beat)
You're welcome.

Dane straightens his back as a beaming smile crests his face.

DANE
Thank you!

Dane looks down at the board.

DANE (CONT'D)
And, I landed on a house!
(to Kelly Mae)
Add that beautiful split level
ranch to my portfolio, my dear!

Kelly Mae stares blankly at Dane.

KELLY MAE
Oh, so I'm your assistant now?

DANE
Good point.
(to Bob)
So when do we get assistants?

Bob bristles.

BOB
We've just gotten out of a nose
dive with the show.
(beat)
I'm just happy we're still on the
air.
(beat)
Do your part, build the viewership,
and maybe in a year or two we can
talk about assistants.

DANE
Nose dive?
(beat)
You mean, Reidel?

Bob bristles again.

BOB
Let me get the Pepto.

CROSSFADE TO:

INT. BOB'S OFFICE - JAKE'S PLACE

Alec sits at the desk with his legs up.

Alec tosses the MAGIC 8 BALL from hand to hand, not bothering
to look at the message that would surface.

BOB (V.O.)
The thing about Alec was his
effortless ability to push me to
the brink of insanity.
(beat)
And then his remarkable skill to
talk me back from the ledge.

Bob enters.

BOB
Is that little Alec?

Alec bristles and brings his feet down off the desk.

ALEC
Bob, it's Mister Reidel now.

Bob stops in his tracks.

BOB
Oh, I'm...
(beat)
Sorry...
(beat)
Mister-

Alec bursts out laughing and stands to slap Bob on the shoulder.

ALEC
I'm just messing with you!
(beat)
Call me Alec.

Bob laughs.

BOB
Okay, Alec. I just wanted to go
over the show format with you once
more.

ALEC
Bob, Bob, Bob.
(beat)
You forget, I'm a Reidel.
(beat)
Being a newsman is in my blood. We
can't lose!

Alec slaps Bob's shoulder again.

ALEC (CONT'D)
Look, this is my show now.
(beat)
I want you to work as hard for me
as you did for my dad.

Alec exits briskly.

Bob turns and watches Alec go.

BOB

But...

(beat)

Your dad worked for **me**...

CUT TO:

INT. GAME NIGHT

Dane and Kelly Mae sit enraptured in the story.

BOB

That was nearly two years ago.

(beat)

His first day.

(beat)

And my first day seeing him all grown up.

OLIVIA

He was...

(beat)

Forceful. But virtuous.

(beat)

I just wish I got more stories on the air.

DANE

Stories? Wait, is the news fictional?

Kelly Mae sighs.

KELLY MAE

(to the group)

Do you see what I've had to deal with for the past six years?

DANE

And not once has it gotten weird!

Kelly Mae moves her game piece.

KELLY MAE

Another baby?!

DANE

These **are** your child bearing years, KM.

(beat)

Bob, Kelly Mae needs a second car for all her babies!

(beat)

(MORE)

DANE (CONT'D)
And Big Daddy Dane needs a potty
break!

Dane gets up and walks off.

Bob leans in.

BOB
Are we going to be okay?

Kelly Mae waves Bob off.

KELLY MAE
Oh he's just getting warmed up...

Dane exclaims from the wings.

DANE (O.S)
She's got so many babies!
(beat)
Babies outcha ass!

The trio at the table bristle then burst into laughter.

Fade to black